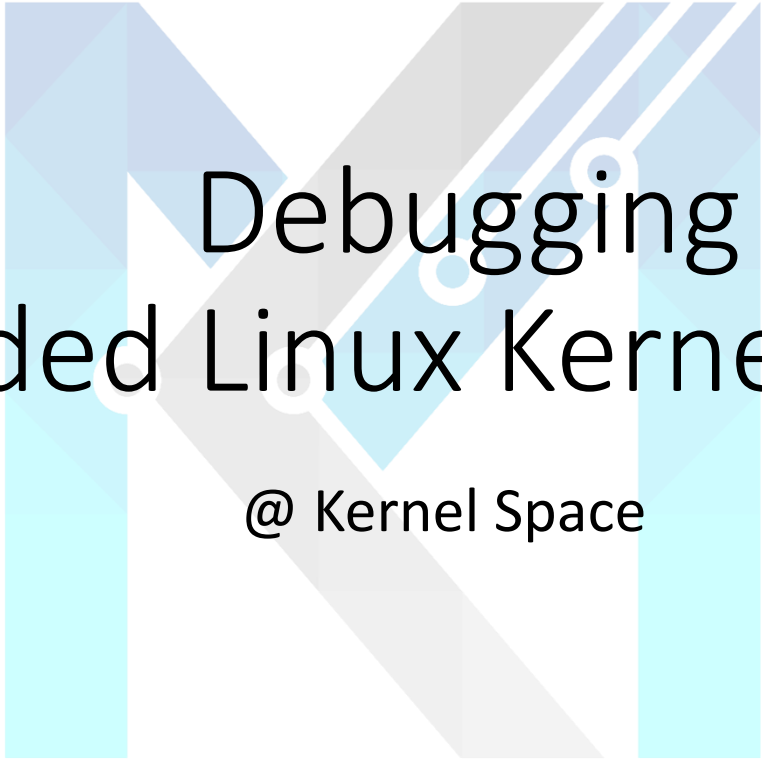




Debugging Embedded Linux Kernel & Drivers

@ Kernel Space

Content

- Kernel Panic
- Kprobe
- KDB
- KGDB



Kernel Panic

Kernel Oops message Analysis

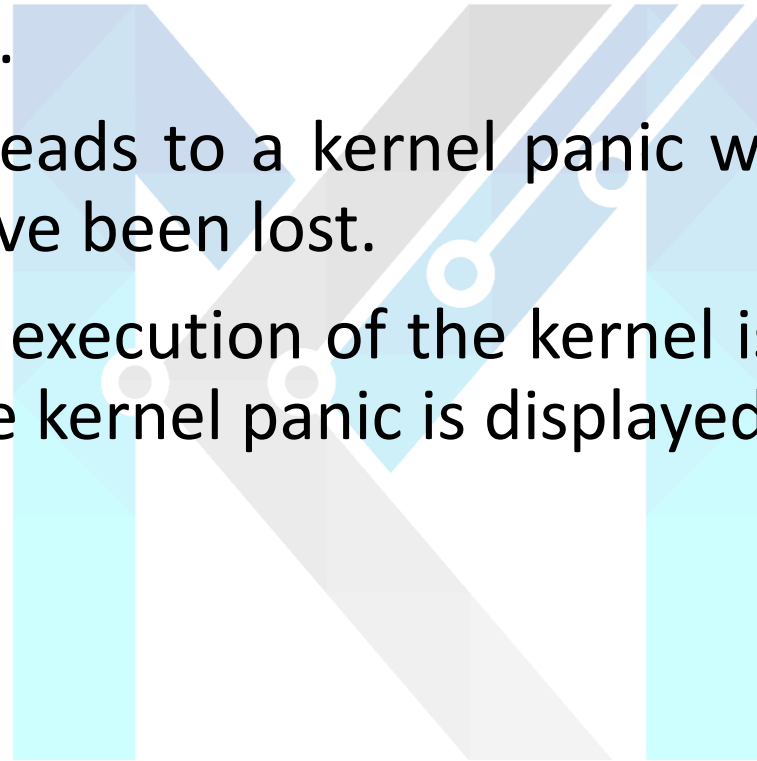


KERNEL OOPS

- **Kernel oops** is a way for the Linux kernel to communicate the user that a certain error has occurred.
- When the kernel detects a problem, it kills any offending processes and prints an oops message in the log, including the current system status and a **stack trace**.
- Different kind of errors could generate a kernel oops, including an illegal memory access or the execution of invalid instructions.
- The official Linux kernel documentation about handling oops messages is available at [Documentation/admin-guide/bug-hunting.rst](https://www.kernel.org/doc/Documentation/admin-guide/bug-hunting.rst)

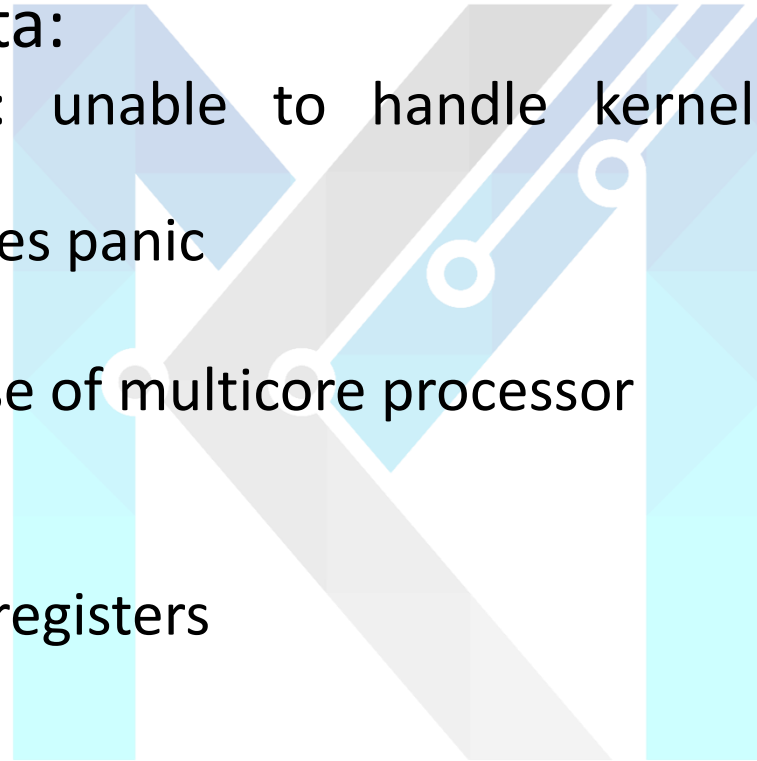
KERNEL PANIC

- After a system has experienced an oops, some internal resources may no longer be operational.
- A kernel oops often leads to a kernel panic when the system attempts to use resources that have been lost.
- In a kernel panic, the execution of the kernel is interrupted and a message with the reason of the kernel panic is displayed in the kernel logs.



KERNEL OOPS Message

- Whenever kernel goes to panic stage it creates a OOPS message which contains following data:
 - BUG Summary: BUG: unable to handle kernel NULL pointer dereference at (null)
 - Which Function creates panic
 - Board Information
 - Which CPU runs incase of multicore processor
 - Kernel Version
 - Back Trace
 - CPU Registers & Flag registers
 - Processor Mode
 - Application PID
 - Application Name
 - Module Name



KERNEL OOPS -1

```
[ 59.939827] pid:594 comm:insmod
[ 59.943034] Unable to handle kernel NULL pointer dereference at virtual address 00000000
[ 59.951393] pgd = fa05fd18
[ 59.954121] [00000000] *pgd=00000000
[ 59.957793] Internal error: Oops: 5 [#1] SMP ARM
Entering kdb (current=0xdd7d2e40, pid 594) on processor 0 Oops: (null)
due to oops @ 0xbf417034
CPU: 0 PID: 594 Comm: insmod Tainted: P      O      4.19.94-Kernel-Masters-g001db1705-dirty #2
Hardware name: Generic AM33XX (Flattened Device Tree)
PC is at panic_init+0x34/0x50 [panic]
LR is at panic_init+0x28/0x50 [panic]
pc : [<bf417034>]   lr : [<bf417028>]   psr: 600f0013
sp : dd5ebdc0 ip : 00000007 fp : c0b88948
r10: bf419000 r9 : 00000028 r8 : 00000000
r7 : bf417000 r6 : c0b88948 r5 : c0b8896c r4 : c0c46100
r3 : 00000000 r2 : e90463b7 r1 : 00000007 r0 : bf418068
Flags: nZCv IRQs on FIQs on Mode SVC_32 ISA ARM Segment none
Control: 10c5387d Table: 9b61c019 DAC: 00000051
CPU: 0 PID: 594 Comm: insmod Tainted: P      O      4.19.94-Kernel-Masters-g001db1705-dirty #2
```

KERNEL OOPS - 2

Hardware name: Generic AM33XX (Flattened Device Tree)

[<c001addc>] (unwind_backtrace) from [<c0014f2c>] (show_stack+0x10/0x14)
[<c0014f2c>] (show_stack) from [<c080a7cc>] (dump_stack+0xe4/0x11c)
[<c080a7cc>] (dump_stack) from [<c0131140>] (kdb_main_loop+0x328/0x7a0)
[<c0131140>] (kdb_main_loop) from [<c0133e2c>] (kdb_stub+0x214/0x444)
[<c0133e2c>] (kdb_stub) from [<c012a000>] (kgdb_cpu_enter+0x428/0x77c)
[<c012a000>] (kgdb_cpu_enter) from [<c012a534>] (kgdb_handle_exception+0xc4/0x220)
[<c012a534>] (kgdb_handle_exception) from [<c001a450>] (kgdb_notify+0x2c/0x64)
[<c001a450>] (kgdb_notify) from [<c006acec>] (notifier_call_chain+0x48/0x80)
[<c006acec>] (notifier_call_chain) from [<c006af64>] (__atomic_notifier_call_chain+0x70/0x120)
[<c006af64>] (__atomic_notifier_call_chain) from [<c006b0a0>] (notify_die+0x6c/0xc4)
[<c006b0a0>] (notify_die) from [<c0015094>] (die+0x164/0x368)
[<c0015094>] (die) from [<c001fa30>] (__do_kernel_fault.part.0+0x54/0x74)
[<c001fa30>] (__do_kernel_fault.part.0) from [<c0827b04>] (do_page_fault+0x3b8/0x3d0)
[<c0827b04>] (do_page_fault) from [<c001fb20>] (do_DataAbort+0x44/0xe4)
[<c001fb20>] (do_DataAbort) from [<c0009944>] (__dabt_svc+0x64/0xa0)

KERNEL OOPS - 3

Exception stack(0xdd5ebd70 to 0xdd5ebdb8)

bd60: bf418068 00000007 e90463b7 00000000

bd80: c0c46100 c0b8896c c0b88948 bf417000 00000000 00000028 bf419000 c0b88948

bda0: 00000007 dd5ebdc0 bf417028 bf417034 600f0013 ffffffff

[<c0009944>] (__dabt_svc) from [<bf417034>] (panic_init+0x34/0x50 [panic])

[<bf417034>] (panic_init [panic]) from [<c000afd8>] (do_one_initcall+0x80/0x318)

[<c000afd8>] (do_one_initcall) from [<c00fb588>] (do_init_module+0x5c/0x1f8)

[<c00fb588>] (do_init_module) from [<c00fda10>] (load_module+0x2284/0x25a4)

[<c00fda10>] (load_module) from [<c00fdf98>] (sys_finit_module+0xbc/0xdc)

[<c00fdf98>] (sys_finit_module) from [<c0009000>] (ret_fast_syscall+0x0/0x28)

Exception stack(0xdd5ebfa8 to 0xdd5ebff0)

bfa0: 4c4d7800 00000000 00000003 0044e7e0 00000000 beb60c68

bfc0: 4c4d7800 00000000 00000000 0000017b 00464560 00000000 beb60de8 00000000

bfe0: beb60c18 beb60c08 00446e41 b6d80d92

ADDR2LINE

- The addr2line tool is capable of converting a memory address into a line of source code:

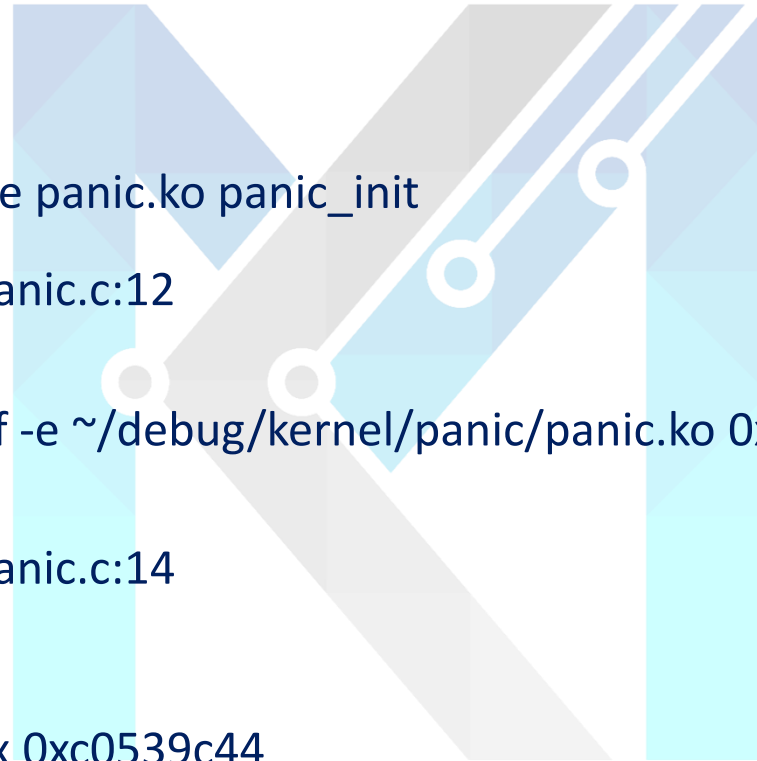
Example 1:

```
arm-linux-gnueabihf-addr2line -f -e panic.ko panic_init  
init_module  
/home/km/debug/kernel/panic/panic.c:12
```

```
$ arm-linux-gnueabihf-addr2line -f -e ~/debug/kernel/panic/panic.ko 0x34  
init_module  
/home/km/debug/kernel/panic/panic.c:14
```

Example 2:

```
$ arm-linux-addr2line -f -e vmlinux 0xc0539c44  
mcp23sxx_spi_read  
/home/sprado/elce/linux/drivers/pinctrl/pinctrl-mcp23s08.c:357
```



FADDR2LINE

- The faddr2line kernel script will translate a stack dump function offset into a source code line:

```
$ ./scripts/faddr2line vmlinux mcp23sxx_spi_read+0x34  
mcp23sxx_spi_read+0x34/0x80:  
mcp23sxx_spi_read at drivers/pinctrl/pinctrl-mcp23s08.c:357
```

panic_init+0x34/0x50

<fun_name>+<offset>/<fun_size>



GDB LIST

Example 1:

```
$ arm-linux-gdb vmlinux
(gdb) list *(mcp23sxx_spi_read+0x34)
```

0xc0539c44 is in mcp23sxx_spi_read (drivers/pinctrl/pinctrl-mcp23s08.c:**357**).

```
352 u8 tx[2];
```

```
353
```

```
354 if (reg_size != 1)
```

```
355 return -EINVAL;
```

```
356
```

```
357 tx[0] = mcp->addr | 0x01;
```

```
358 tx[1] = *((u8 *) reg);
```

```
359
```

```
360 spi = to_spi_device(mcp->dev);
```

Example 2:

```
$ arm-linux-gnueabi-gdb panic.ko
```

```
(gdb) list *(panic_init+0x34)
```

0x34 is in panic_init (/home/km/debug/kernel/panic/panic.c:**14**).

```
9
```

```
10 int *ptr=NULL;
```

```
11
```

```
12 static int panic_init(void) {
```

```
13     printk("pid:%d comm:%s\n",current->pid,current->comm);
```

```
14     printk("%d\n",*ptr); //creates kernel panic
```

```
15     return 0;
```

```
16 }
```

```
17
```

```
18 static void panic_exit(void) {
```

GDB DISASSEMBLE

Panic Example:

```
$ arm-linux-gnueabi-gdb panic.ko
```

```
(gdb) disass panic_init
```

```
Dump of assembler code for function panic_init:
```

```
0x00000000 <+0>:      andeq    r0, r0, r4
0x00000004 <+4>:      andeq    r0, r0, r4, lsl r0
0x00000008 <+8>:      andeq    r0, r0, r3
0x0000000c <+12>:     subseq    r4, r5, r7, asr #28
0x00000010 <+16>:     cmpne    r9, #-1073741816      ;
0xc0000008
0x00000014 <+20>:     mcrcc    15, 2, pc, cr11, cr2, {7}      ;
<UNPREDICTABLE>
0x00000018 <+24>:     rschi    r6, r4, #80, 16 ; 0x500000
0x0000001c <+28>:     bhi     0xfe66abcc
0x00000020 <+32>:     ldrhi    r8, [r6, #1237]! ; 0x4d5
0x00000024 <+36>:     bl      0x24 <panic_init+36>
0x00000028 <+40>:     ldr      r3, [pc, #24] ; 0x48 <panic_init+72>
0x0000002c <+44>:     ldr      r0, [pc, #24] ; 0x4c <panic_init+76>
0x00000030 <+48>:     ldr      r3, [r3]
0x00000034 <+52>:     ldr      r1, [r3]
0x00000038 <+56>:     bl      0x38 <panic_init+56>
0x0000003c <+60>:     mov     r0, #0
--Type <RET> for more, q to quit, c to continue without paging--
0x00000040 <+64>:     pop     {r4, pc}
0x00000044 <+68>:     andeq    r0, r0, r0
0x00000048 <+72>:     andeq    r0, r0, r0
0x0000004c <+76>:     andeq    r0, r0, r0, lsl r0
```

```
End of assembler dump.
```

```
(gdb) list *(0x00000034)
```

```
0x34 is in panic_init (/home/km/debug/kernel/panic/panic.c:14).
```

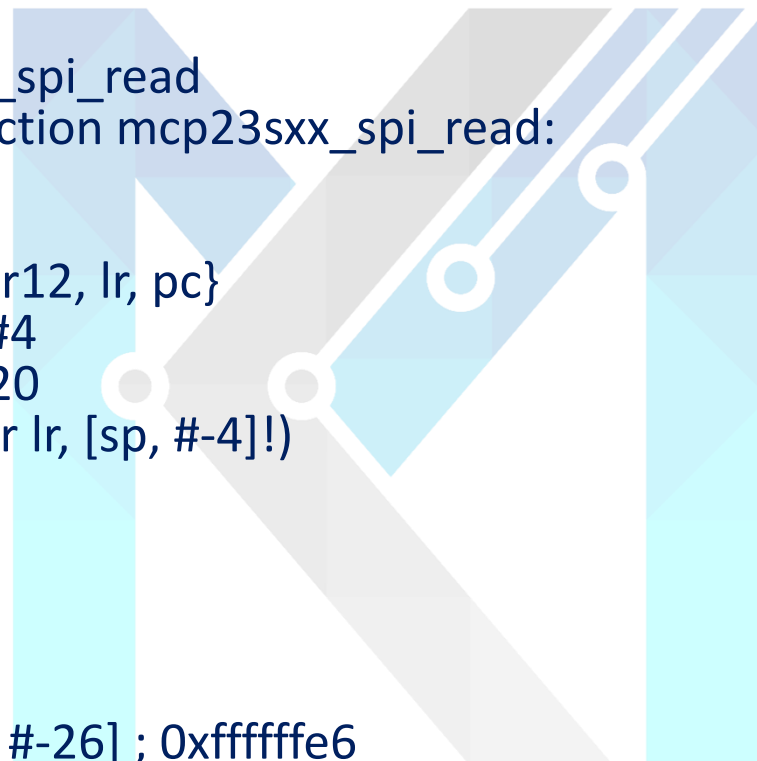
```
9
10 int *ptr=NULL;
11
12 static int panic_init(void) {
13     printk("pid:%d comm:%s\n",current->pid,current->comm);
14     printk("%d\n",*ptr); //creates kernel panic
15     return 0;
16 }
17
18 static void panic_exit(void) {
```

GDB DISASSEMBLE

```
$ arm-linux-gdb vmlinux
```

```
(gdb) disassemble /m mcp23sxx_spi_read  
Dump of assembler code for function mcp23sxx_spi_read:
```

```
349 {  
0xc0539c10 <+0>: mov r12, sp  
0xc0539c14 <+4>: push {r4, r11, r12, lr, pc}  
0xc0539c18 <+8>: sub r11, r12, #4  
0xc0539c1c <+12>: sub sp, sp, #20  
0xc0539c20 <+16>: push {lr} ; (str lr, [sp, #-4]!)  
[...]  
357 tx[0] = mcp->addr | 0x01;  
0xc0539c3c <+44>: mov r0, #0  
0xc0539c44 <+52>: ldrb r1, [r0]  
0xc0539c54 <+68>: orr r1, r1, #1  
0xc0539c58 <+72>: strb r1, [r11, #-26] ; 0xffffffffe6  
[...]
```



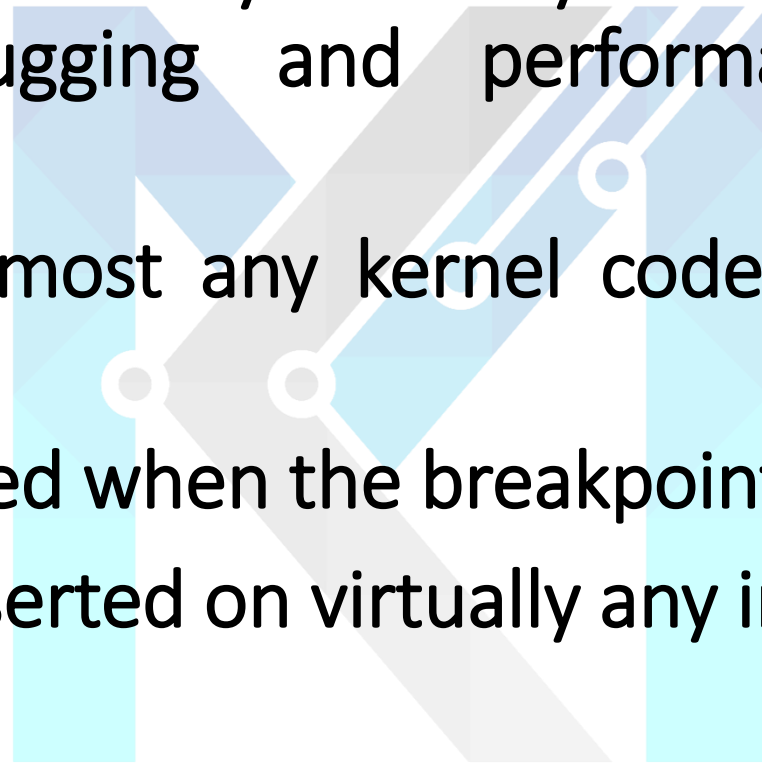
Kernel Probes

Kprobe



Kprobe

- Kprobes enables you to dynamically break into any kernel routine and collect debugging and performance information non-disruptively.
- You can trap at almost any kernel code address(*), specifying a handler.
- routine to be invoked when the breakpoint is hit.
- A kprobe can be inserted on virtually any instruction in the kernel.



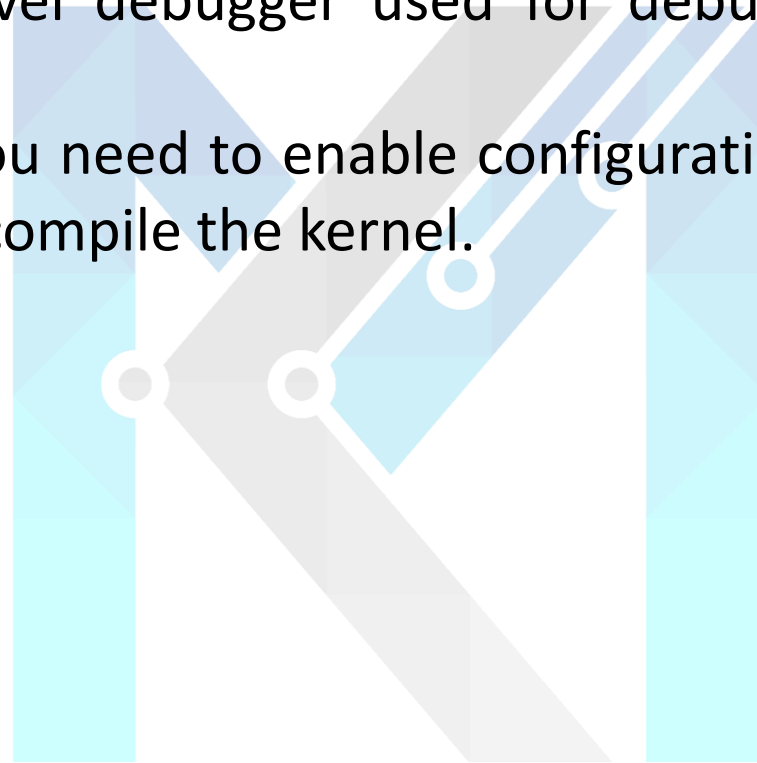
KDB/KGDB

Instruction level Debugger/Source level Debugger

What is KDB?

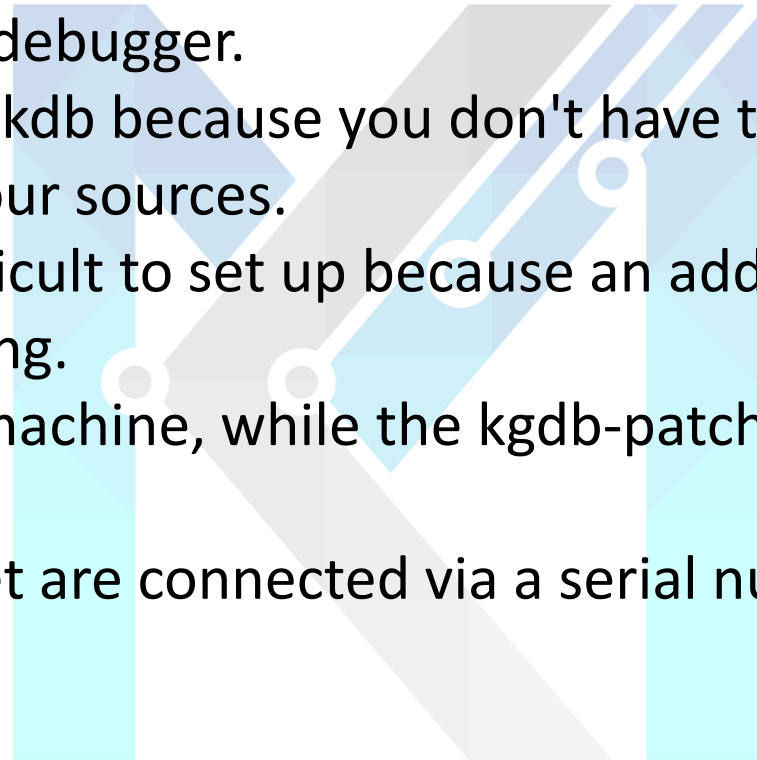
Kernel Debugger (kdb):

- Kdb is an instruction-level debugger used for debugging kernel code and device drivers.
- Before you can use it, you need to enable configuration options your kernel sources with kdb support and recompile the kernel.



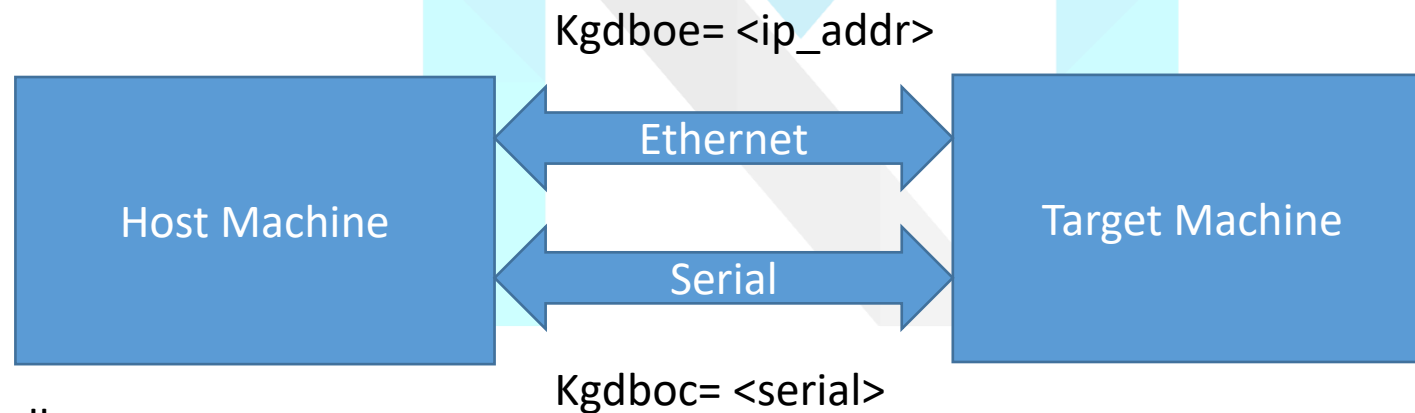
What is KGDB?

- Kgdb is a source-level debugger.
- It is easier to use than kdb because you don't have to spend time correlating assembly code with your sources.
- However it's more difficult to set up because an additional machine is needed to front-end the debugging.
- gdb runs on the host machine, while the kgdb-patched kernel runs on the target hardware.
- The host and the target are connected via a serial null-modem cable .



What is KGDB?

- Two machines are required for using kgdb.
- One of these machines is a development machine and the other is the target machine. The kernel to be debugged runs on the target machine.
- The development machine runs an instance of gdb against the vmlinux file which contains the symbols (not boot image such as bzImage, zImage, ulmage...).
- In gdb the developer specifies the connection parameters and connects to kgdb



Host running gdb

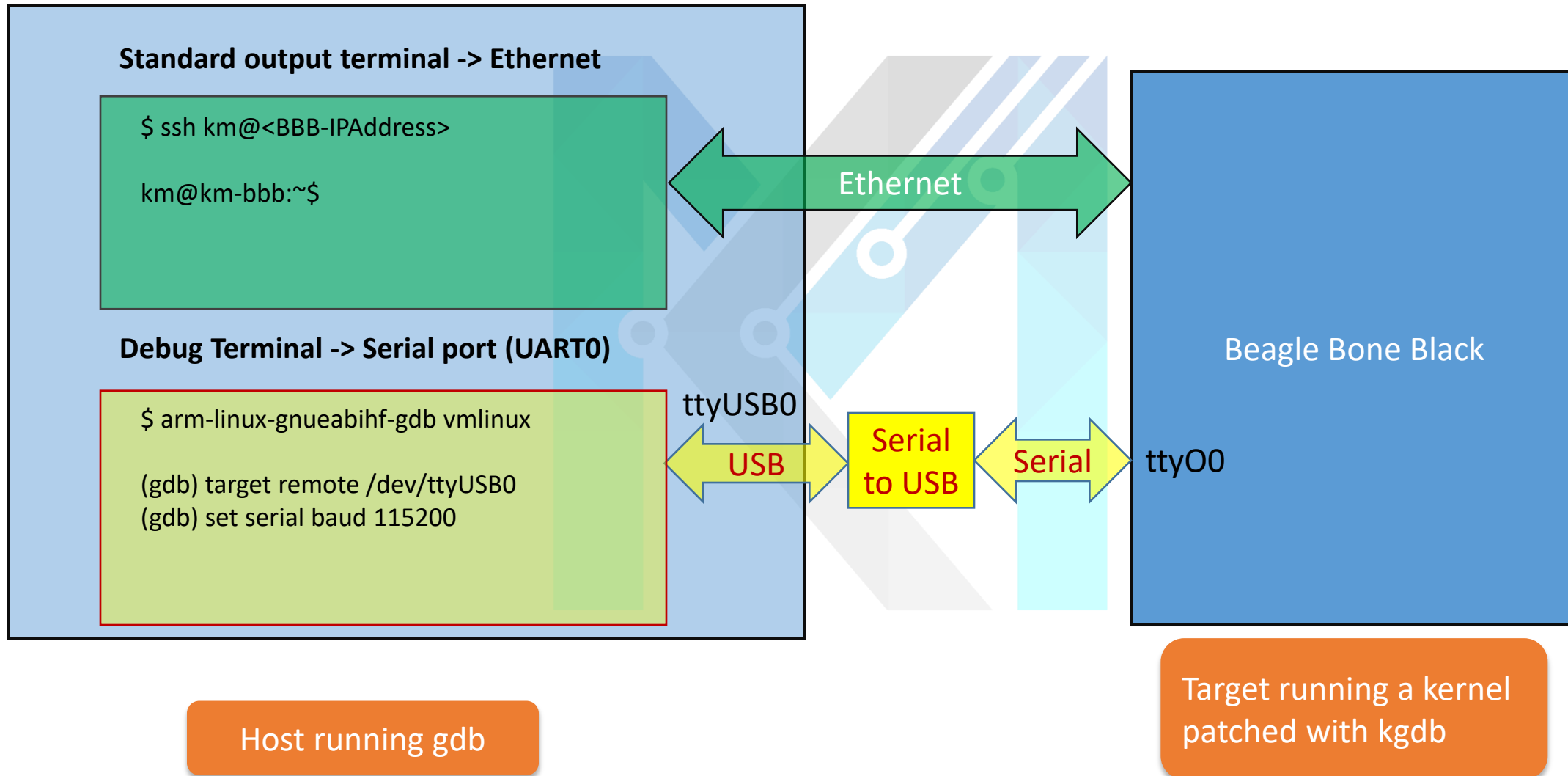
```
$ arm-linux-gnueabi-gdb vmlinux
```

```
(gdb) b printk
```

```
(gdb) c
```

Target running a kernel patched with kgdb

KGDB Setup



KDB vs KGDB

Parameter	KDB	KGDB
Advantage	KDB easy to set up, because you don't need an additional machine to do the debugging	KGDB more difficult to set up because an additional machine is needed to front-end the debugging.
Disadvantage	you need to correlate your sources with disassembled code	Don't have to spend time correlating assembly code with your sources
Debugger Environment	It is a debugger that needs to be built inside the kernel. All it requires is a console using which commands can be entered and output displayed on the console.	It requires a development machine to run the debugger as a normal process that communicates with the target using the GDB protocol over a serial cable. Recent versions of KGDB support the Ethernet interface.

KDB vs KGDB

Parameter	KDB	KGDB
Support for source-level debugging	No support for source-level debugging	Support for source-level debugging provided the kernel is compiled with the -g flag on the development machine and the kernel source tree is available. On the development machine where the debugger application runs, -g option tells gcc to generate debugging information while compiling, which in conjunction with source files provides source-level debugging.

KDB vs KGDB

Parameter	KDB	KGDB
Kernel module debugging	KDB provides support for kernel module debugging.	Debugging modules using KGDB is tricky because the module is loaded on the target machine and the debugger (GDB) runs on a different machine; so the KGDB debugger needs to be informed of the module load address. KGDB 1.9 is accompanied by a special GDB that can automatically detect module loading and unloading. For KGDB versions equal to or less than 1.8, the developer has to make use of an explicit GDB command <code>add symbol-file</code> to load the module object into GDB's memory along with the module load address.

KDB vs KGDB

Parameter	KDB	KGDB
Debugging features offered	The most commonly used debugging features of KDB are: displaying and modifying memory and registers applying breakpoints stack back trace Along with the user-applied breakpoints, KDB is invoked when the kernel hits an irrecoverable error condition such as panic or OOPS. The user can use the output of KDB to diagnose the problem	Supports GDB execution control commands, stack trace, and KGDB-specific watch points among a host of other feature such as thread analysis.